[their] way' to worship was 'not doing the will of God'.

The story of the jizya is even more complicated.

'Who can estimate the amount thereof?' Abul Fazl exclaims, heralding its removal in 1564. But what was money to a man creating a new world order?

Historically, by Abul Fazl's explanation, the tax was collected for three reasons: to aid in the 'contempt and destruction of opposite factions'; for 'political purposes'; and for material gain. Akbar's remission of the tax invited ideological and financial resistance, therefore, but the emperor persisted despite 'the disapproval of statesmen, and of the great revenue, and of much chatter on the part of the ignorant'. Akbar, on the other hand, heir to Adam and ruler of all men, was a unifier; his personality and policies had ensured that 'those who belong to other religions have, like those of one mind and one religion, bound up the waist of devotion', and no longer 'cherished mortal enmity' against the throne. Given all this, and the prosperity of the empire besides, how could any 'just and discriminating mind apply itself to collecting this tax'?

Having penned his eloquent paean to his emperor's 'abundant good-will' and 'sublime decree', Abul Fazl may have been too embarrassed to record that in 1575, a little over ten years after removing it, Akbar brought the jizya right back.

Iqtidar Alam Khan has argued that both the remittance and the resumption of the jizya had clear political reasons.[36] In 1564, Akbar was recruiting Rajputs to his court. It was also in this year of the jizya's abolition, however, that the first of his Uzbek warlords began to sow insurrectionist oats in Malwa; the very next year the Uzbek rebellion broke out in full force. In the course of battling Ali Quli and Bahadur, Akbar seems to have tweaked his larger political paradigm.

Now the emperor felt compelled to prove his Islamic credentials to his restless Central Asian warlords and his newly recruited Indian Muslim courtiers and commanders. Thus, the massacre of civilians in Chittorgarh and the characterization of its conquest as a victory over 'infidels'.[37] And thus, too, the re-imposition of the jizya in 1575.

Abul Fazl doesn't mention this complete about-face, but it may be that Badauni is alluding to it when he writes of how Akbar ordered Makhdum-